

You can access the basic interface from `Windows Control Panel > System and Security > Windows Firewall`). If you want to allow an app or feature through the firewall, you have the option on the left pane. Be warned though – that feature doesn't help you restrict a program, only allow it. If you want to restrict a program for inbound and outbound traffic, you'd need to open Windows Firewall with Advanced Security (WFAS), which can be accessed by clicking 'Advanced settings' on the left pane. Before we proceed, we should inform you that WFAS is not a separate firewall; it's just an advanced interface to the same technology.

Though intimidating at first, WFAS is a pretty good tool to block traffic. The rules are classified into two main types:

1. **Outbound Rules:** They're basically there to restrict the initiation of communication by a local program or service. They'd be applicable to most programs and services we use. So if you don't want Firefox to access the internet, this is where you create the rule.
2. **Inbound Rules:** They restrict / allow a connection coming from another computer to your computer. The rules here are useful for background services such as a print service, Web server, Database server, FTP service etc. Though in most cases the rules enabled by default suffice, you can create one of your own. This you can do by right-clicking the rule type (Outbound/Inbound) in the left pane and selecting 'New Rule...' from the menu. All rules can be applied to any and all network types – Public, Private and Domain. Remember though – the Domain network type exists in Windows 8 Pro and Enterprise editions only.

Windows 8 takes the solid security foundations developed into the Windows architecture over the course of the past 14 years and improves them by utilizing more hardware features. Features such as Forced ASLR and HEASLR improve the security on the software level and are aimed to defeat malicious hackers. The AppContainer feature, along with strict manifest checks help build confidence and reliability on Modern UI apps. NTFS, BitLocker and EFS, as always stand firm in the background to secure your data from potential file system attacks offline. 